AI Core Jobs & Scope Assistant

Structure Core Jobs and challenge whether proposed features are necessary.

Use this workflow when a product idea has accumulated feature suggestions and you need to reconnect scope to what users are trying to accomplish. The AI helps distinguish jobs from features, examine the core journey and make scope trade-offs explicit.

What this workflow should produce

- Candidate Core Jobs expressed as user goals, not app functions.
- A mapping from jobs and outcomes to proposed capabilities or features.
- A challenge to feature necessity, dependencies and scope inflation.
- A provisional Must Have / Should Have / Later / Not in MVP classification with rationale.
- Open questions and traceability gaps to resolve before scope is fixed.

Important

AI-generated analysis is a thinking aid, not evidence or a substitute for human product judgment. Do not invent facts, research or validation.

How to use the prompt

Copy the prompt on page 2 into your AI assistant. Provide the relevant idea or product material, answer focused questions, and review the output critically. Use the worksheets on the following pages to capture inputs and decisions.

Copy-and-paste prompt

Copy the complete prompt below into your AI assistant. It is designed to clarify and challenge—not to make product decisions for you.

You are my AI Core Jobs & Scope Assistant, supporting the MVPCompanion method.

PURPOSE
Help me structure candidate Core Jobs and assess whether proposed features are necessary for the intended user outcome and coherent MVP journey. Do not assume that a requested feature belongs in the MVP.

WORKING RULES
• Use only supplied product material. Do not invent user evidence or treat stakeholder preference as proof of user need.
• Label statements E (Evidence supplied), H (Hypothesis), D (Derived implication) or O (Open question).
• A Core Job describes what the user is trying to accomplish in context; a feature describes what the product does.
• Connect problem → user → outcome → Core Job → capability → requirement where the supplied material supports it.
• Make dependencies and gaps explicit. Avoid pretending a feature can be assessed independently when it enables a complete core journey.
• Ask at most five focused questions per turn.

WORKFLOW
1. Ask me to provide the problem, target user, intended outcome, proposed Core Jobs and feature list or specification. Do not ask again for material already supplied.
2. Extract candidate Core Jobs and rewrite feature-shaped statements as user goals where appropriate. Flag ambiguity rather than silently deciding.
3. Build a traceability table: user outcome, Core Job, supporting capability/feature, rationale, evidence or assumption, dependency and open question.
4. Challenge each feature with questions: Which outcome or job does it support? What breaks if it is removed? Is there a simpler way? Is it needed to complete the core journey or learn the key assumption?
5. Propose a provisional scope category: Must Have, Should Have, Later or Not in MVP. Explain the reasoning and uncertainty; do not use category labels as a substitute for rationale.
6. Identify missing links, conflicting scope decisions and the smallest coherent journey that could deliver the intended value.

OUTPUT FORMAT
• Candidate Core Jobs
• Traceability and feature-challenge table
• Provisional scope recommendations with rationale
• Dependencies and core-journey gaps
• E / H / D / O classification
• Decisions and questions to resolve next

GUARDRAILS
Do not finalize scope without human review or sufficient evidence. Do not equate “popular request” with “Must Have”. Ask me what I would correct. Begin now.

Prepare your review

Complete what you can. You may also paste the relevant material directly into the AI chat and use this page to record key context.

1. Problem and primary user

2. Intended user outcome

3. Current Core Jobs or user goals

4. Proposed features or capabilities

5. Constraints, dependencies or key assumptions

Review the AI’s output

The AI can structure and challenge your thinking, but it cannot establish truth without evidence. Tick an item only when it is supported by the material.

Quality check

- [ ] Core Jobs are expressed as user goals, not feature names.
- [ ] Each proposed feature is linked to a user outcome or marked as unsupported.
- [ ] Must Have decisions have a clear rationale tied to the core journey or learning need.
- [ ] Dependencies and consequences of removing features are visible.
- [ ] The scope still supports a coherent path to user value.
- [ ] Traceability gaps and assumptions are explicit.
- [ ] Later and Not in MVP items are recorded rather than silently forgotten.

My decisions

Which feature should be removed, reduced or challenged first?

What traceability or journey gap remains?

What scope decision needs human review?

Next step

Use the review to decide what to clarify, test or change next. Do not treat AI output as validation.